VOL. I · NO. 5 MONDAYS & THURSDAYS

THE LAUNCH REPORT

Rocket launches, reentries and the business of spaceflight, worldwide

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026 ALL TIMES EASTERN DAYLIGHT TIME (EDT)

THE WEEK IN LAUNCH

Five launches, five successes since Thursday

Rocket Lab's Electron put three HawkEye 360 satellites in orbit early Friday, China flew three Long March rockets from Taiyuan, Jiuquan and Wenchang between Friday morning and Saturday night, and Starlink 15-15 finally left Vandenberg on Friday evening after three earlier scrubs. That brings 2026 to 250 orbital launch attempts, 243 of them successful, according to GCAT.

Two Vandenberg Starlinks have moved a day later, India's GSLV now has a firm date of Friday, and United Launch Alliance's Vulcan with Amazon Leo LV-01 has slipped from late October into November. In Texas, Starship's Booster 22 completed a full-duration static fire on Sunday ahead of Flight 15.

I · RECENT LAUNCHES & RETURNS

Starlink 15-15 flies on the fourth try

Electron and Falcon 9 each delivered on Friday, and China launched 16 satellites on three Long Marches.

Electron: "We're Not Hawking Around"

The 98th Electron lifted off from Launch Complex 1 on New Zealand's Mahia Peninsula at 3:11 a.m. EDT Friday (07:11 UTC; Launch Library 2) with three HAWK radio-frequency-sensing satellites for HawkEye 360, bound for a 520-kilometer orbit inclined 97 degrees (Rocket Lab). At 4:08 a.m., Rocket Lab posted: "Payload deployment confirmed from Electron - all three HAWK satellites for @hawkeye360 are now on orbit" (post). The flight, delayed from October 21 for a telemetry review, launched on its first attempt and was Rocket Lab's 19th mission of the year and its third for HawkEye 360, the company said.

Long March 6A: Yaogan-50 03

A Long March 6A, which Xinhua called a modified Long March-6, launched from Taiyuan at 6:15 a.m. EDT Friday (10:15 UTC) and placed Yaogan-50 03 in its planned orbit. Xinhua said the satellite will be used for land surveys, crop-yield estimation and disaster relief; it was the 672nd flight of a Long March rocket (Xinhua; Launch Library 2).

Long March 4B: six Yaogan satellites

A Long March 4B lifted off from Launch Area 94 at Jiuquan at 3:25 p.m. EDT Friday (19:25 UTC) with Yaogan-53 07 to 09 and Yaogan-56 19 to 21, which reached their preset orbits. Xinhua said they will be used mainly for scientific experiments, land and resources surveys, crop-yield estimation and disaster prevention; it was the 673rd Long March mission (Xinhua; Launch Library 2).



A Falcon 9 lifts off from Space Launch Complex 4E at Vandenberg Space Force Base with NASA's SWOT satellite on Dec. 16, 2022. Starlink 15-15 flew from the same pad on Friday.

PHOTO: NASA/KEEGAN BARBER · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Falcon 9: Starlink 15-15

Falcon 9 launched from Space Launch Complex 4E at Vandenberg at 6:48 p.m. EDT Friday (22:48 UTC), following three scrubs earlier in the week, Spaceflight Now reported. Booster B1063 was on its 36th flight (NASASpaceflight), and SpaceX posted at 7:51 p.m.: "Deployment of 27 @Starlink satellites confirmed" (post).

Long March 8A: SatNet LEO Group 28

A Long March 8A lifted off from Commercial Launch Complex 1 at Wenchang, Hainan, at 10:03 p.m. EDT Saturday (02:03 UTC Sunday), 13 minutes after the time listed in Thursday's issue, with nine low-Earth-orbit communications satellites for the state-owned SatNet constellation operated by China Satellite Network Group, which is to grow to 13,000 satellites (Launch Library 2).

Two Starlinks and a GSLV this week

Every orbital launch with a date between now and November 30. Times are EDT, with Coordinated Universal Time (UTC) below; NET means no earlier than.

DATE / TIME	VEHICLE	PROVIDER	MISSION / PAYLOAD	SITE	ORBIT	STATUS	SOURCES
Tue Oct 27, 12:45 a.m. 04:45 UTC	Falcon 9	SpaceX	Starlink 15-16: 27 Starlink V2 Mini satellites. Booster B1082, 26th flight	SLC-4E, Vandenberg, Calif.	LEO	**CONFIRMED**	FAA; Spaceflight Now
Fri Oct 30, 12:02 a.m. 04:02 UTC	Falcon 9	SpaceX	Starlink 15-18: 27 Starlink V2 Mini satellites	SLC-4E, Vandenberg, Calif.	LEO	**CONFIRMED**	FAA; Launch Library 2
Fri Oct 30, 2:21 p.m. 18:21 UTC	GSLV Mk II	Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)	NVS-03 (IRNSS-1L), a replacement satellite for India's regional navigation system	Second Launch Pad, Sriharikota, India	GTO	**TENTATIVE**	Launch Library 2
NET Nov 3	Long March 12A	CASC	Flight 2, with a first-stage landing attempt	Jiuquan, China	LEO	**PRELIMINARY**	NASASpaceflight; Launch Library 2 (October)
NET Tue Nov 3	Electron	Rocket Lab	"The Sea God Surveys": iQPS radar imaging satellite	Launch Complex 1, Mahia, New Zealand	LEO	**PRELIMINARY**	Launch Library 2; Spaceflight Now (Nov 4)
Thu Nov 5, 12:14 a.m. EST 05:14 UTC	Falcon 9	SpaceX	Starlink 15-21: 27 Starlink satellites. Booster B1103, seventh flight	SLC-4E, Vandenberg, Calif.	LEO	**TENTATIVE**	Launch Library 2; Spaceflight Now
Thu Nov 5, 5:34 p.m. EST 22:34 UTC	Falcon 9	SpaceX	NROL-195, National Reconnaissance Office	SLC-4E, Vandenberg, Calif.	LEO	**TENTATIVE**	Launch Library 2
NET Tue Nov 10	Electron	Rocket Lab	"The Mountain God Rises": iQPS radar imaging satellite	Launch Complex 1, Mahia, New Zealand	LEO	**PRELIMINARY**	Launch Library 2
NET Mon Nov 23	Ariane 64	Arianespace	VA271: 36 Amazon Leo broadband satellites, 10th Ariane 6	ELA-4, Kourou, French Guiana	LEO	**PRELIMINARY**	Spaceflight Now; Launch Library 2
Tue Nov 24, 12:03 a.m. EST 05:03 UTC	Soyuz-2.1b	Roscosmos	Progress MS-36 cargo ship to the International Space Station	Site 31/6, Baikonur, Kazakhstan	LEO	**TENTATIVE**	Launch Library 2
NET Wed Nov 25	Long March 2F	CASC	Shenzhou 24 crew to the Tiangong station	Launch Area 91, Jiuquan, China	LEO	**PRELIMINARY**	Launch Library 2

CONFIRMED date and time announced by the launch provider, its customer or the FAA. **TENTATIVE** specific date in published schedules or airspace and maritime notices, not yet confirmed by the operator. **PRELIMINARY** target range, or no-earlier-than date or month only.

Abbreviations: SLC, Space Launch Complex; SLC-4E, Space Launch Complex 4 East; ELA-4, Ariane Launch Area 4; LEO, low Earth orbit; GTO, geostationary transfer orbit; GSLV, Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle; CASC, China Aerospace Science and Technology Corp.; EST, Eastern Standard Time, which begins November 1.

Date changes

Starlink 15-16. Saturday, October 24; then Monday, October 26, at 1:00 a.m.; now Tuesday, October 27, at 12:45 a.m., with a backup window early Wednesday (FAA; Spaceflight Now). No reason given.

Starlink 15-18. Thursday, October 29, at 12:17 a.m.; now Friday, October 30, at 12:02 a.m. (FAA). No reason given.

Vulcan with Amazon Leo LV-01. NET Thursday, October 29; now listed only for November (Launch Library 2). No reason given.

GSLV with NVS-03. NET October; now Friday, October 30, at 2:21 p.m. (Launch Library 2).

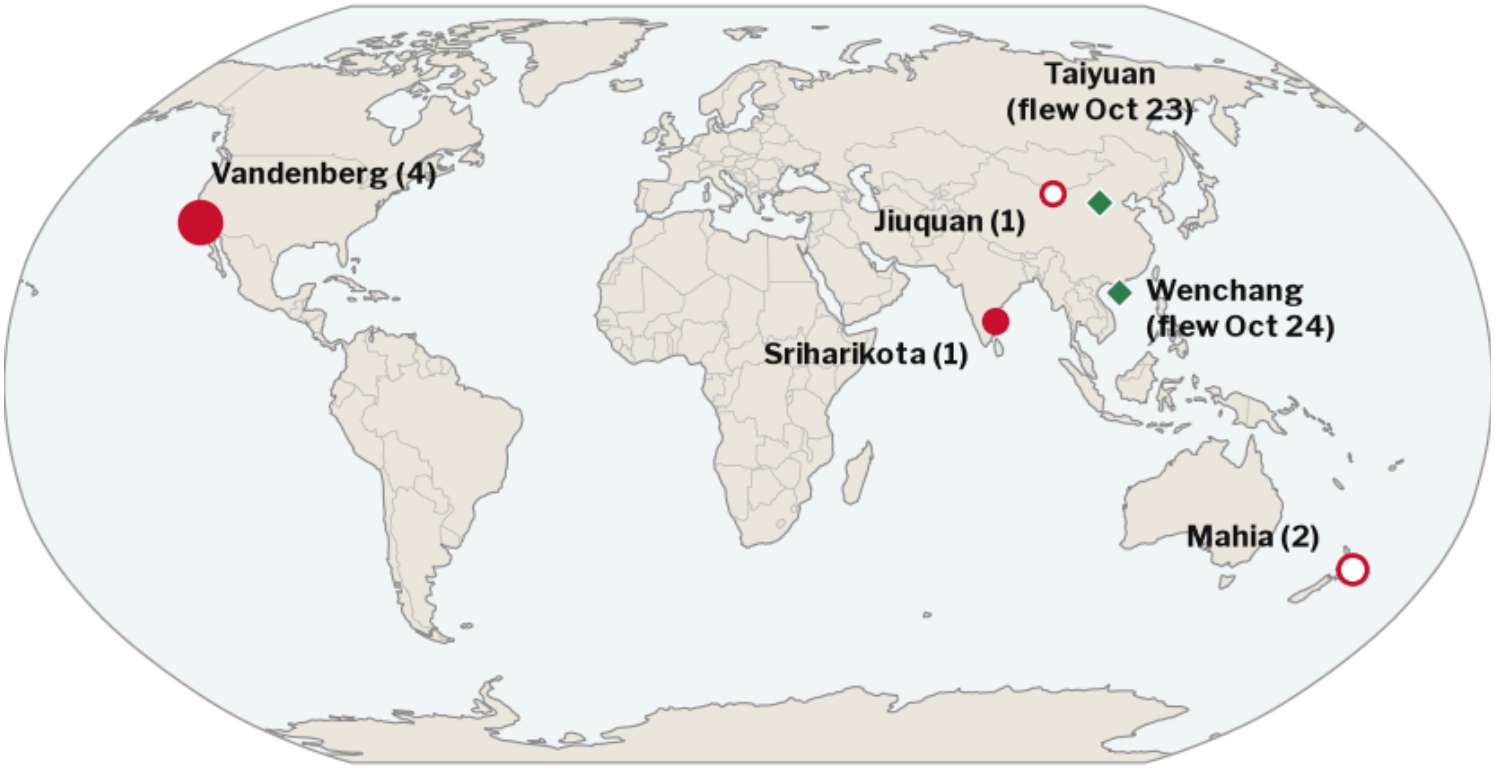
Electron "The Sea God Surveys." NET November 4; now listed for November 3 by Launch Library 2, while Spaceflight Now still shows NET November 4.

SSLV with AayulSAT-1A. Listed for October in Thursday's issue; no longer in the upcoming schedule of Launch Library 2.

Also listed for November without a specific date in Launch Library 2: ISRO's first uncrewed Gaganyaan test flight on LVM-3 and a PSLV-XL with the TDS-01 technology demonstration satellite; the first full orbital launch of a South Korean military small-satellite rocket from an offshore platform; the Vulcan above; and Northrop Grumman's Cygnus NG-25 on a Falcon 9 from Cape Canaveral.

QUICK HIT

Starship. Booster 22's static fire at Starbase at 9:22 a.m. EDT Sunday was part of preparations for "next month's planned Flight 15," Spaceflight Now posted; "SpaceX confirm good full duration Static Fire test," NASASpaceflight posted.



Launch sites with orbital launches listed through November 15; numbers count launches. Filled: dated launch (Confirmed or Tentative). Hollow: Preliminary. Green diamonds: sites that launched since Thursday with nothing scheduled; Vandenberg, Jiuquan and Mahia also launched since Thursday.
MAP: THE LAUNCH REPORT · PAD COORDINATES FROM LAUNCH LIBRARY 2 · NATURAL EARTH

III · TRAJECTORIES & HAZARD AREAS

Airspace windows for two Starlinks and a Mojave flight

The FAA's operations plan lists the times U.S. airspace is set aside; no hazard-area coordinates have been published for these flights.

How they flew

Friday's Electron was bound for a 520-kilometer orbit inclined 97 degrees, close to polar (Rocket Lab). Rocket Lab confirmed payload deployment 57 minutes after liftoff (post). Starlink 15-15 and the two Starlinks due this week launch from the same Vandenberg pad, Space Launch Complex 4E (Spaceflight Now).

Airspace windows

The FAA Air Traffic Control System Command Center's plan for Monday lists these launch windows, converted from UTC (FAA advisory):

FLIGHT	PRIMARY WINDOW	BACKUP
Stratolaunch "Erebus," Mojave Air and Space Port	Mon Oct 26, 9:00 a.m.–1:00 p.m.	Mon Nov 2, 9:00 a.m.–1:00 p.m. EST
Starlink 15-16, Vandenberg	**Tue Oct 27, 12:45–5:28 a.m.**	**Wed Oct 28, 12:31–5:28 a.m.**
Starlink 15-18, Vandenberg	Fri Oct 30, 12:02–4:45 a.m.	Fri Oct 30, 11:48 p.m.–Sat Oct 31, 4:31 a.m.

IV · REENTRIES & ISS TRAFFIC

Seven objects down; a 1973 satellite is next

Five old Starlinks, a Chinese satellite and an Electron kick stage reentered between Friday and Sunday.

Station traffic

The International Space Station's Expedition 75 crew printed blood vessels, cleaned a levitation furnace and got ready for a spacewalk, NASA posted Friday (NASA). The next Russian cargo ship, Progress MS-36, is listed for 12:03 a.m. EST on November 24 from Baikonur, and Northrop Grumman's Cygnus NG-25 is listed for November (Launch Library 2). China's Shenzhou 24 crew flight to Tiangong is NET November 25 (Launch Library 2).

Confirmed reentries

CelesTrak's satellite catalog lists these objects as decayed since Thursday's issue; times are predictions from Aerospace.

OBJECT (CATALOG NO.)	LAUNCHED	REENTRY, EDT	LAST ORBIT, KM
Starlink-1641 (46174)	Aug 18, 2020	Oct 23, 12:50 a.m. ± 1 hr	141 × 144
Electron kick stage (100684)	**Sep 11, 2026**	**Oct 23, 6:18 a.m. ± 5 hr**	**179 × 233**
Yaogan-35 02B (52908)	Jun 23, 2022	Oct 23, 6:36 p.m. ± 2 hr	179 × 184
Starlink-4454 (53499)	Aug 12, 2022	Oct 23, 9:49 p.m. ± 2 hr	140 × 155
Starlink-1704 (47625)	Feb 16, 2021	Oct 24, 1:36 p.m. ± 8 hr	146 × 154
Starlink-1525 (46066)	Aug 7, 2020	Oct 24, 11:35 p.m. ± 10 hr	163 × 173
Starlink-1454 (45671)	Jun 4, 2020	Oct 25, 9:44 a.m. ± 12 hr	173 × 181

CelesTrak records Starlink-1454's decay on October 24, earlier than the Aerospace prediction, and Starlink-1525's on October 25. The kick stage is from Rocket Lab's September 11 "Happily Ever Faster" mission. The five Starlinks that Thursday's issue said had not yet been marked decayed, Starlink-1297, -2131, -1972, -5041 and -30924, are now listed as down on October 20 and 21 (CelesTrak).

Predicted

OBJECT (CATALOG NO.)	LAUNCHED	PREDICTED, EDT
Aureole 2 (7003)	**Dec 26, 1973**	**Tue Oct 27, 6:23 a.m. ± 20 hr**
Rassvet-3 17 (100083)	Jul 19, 2026	Fri Oct 30, 12:16 a.m. ± 36 hr
Rassvet-3 23 (100089)	Jul 19, 2026	Fri Nov 6, 3:15 a.m. EST ± 78 hr

Aureole 2, a French-owned satellite launched from Plesetsk, was in a 185-by-208-kilometer orbit inclined 73.9 degrees (CelesTrak). Rassvet-3 17's predicted reentry has moved about seven hours earlier since Thursday, to 12:16 a.m. Friday, and Rassvet-3 23, from the same launch, has joined the list (Aerospace).



One orbit of Aureole 2, computed from CelesTrak's elements from 9:01 p.m. EDT October 25. Its 73.9-degree inclination, and the Rassvets' 82.3 degrees, mean each can reenter over almost any part of the globe. No current elements were available for the Rassvet satellites.

MAP: THE LAUNCH REPORT · CELESTRAK · NATURAL EARTH

V · INDUSTRY & REGULATION

Artemis III will test two landers in Earth orbit

NASA laid out a 2027 low-Earth-orbit mission for Orion, Blue Origin's Blue Moon and SpaceX's Starship.

Artemis



NASA's concept of operations for Artemis III: Blue Origin's New Glenn launches a Blue Moon Mark 2 test article from Launch Complex 36A, the Space Launch System sends Orion up from Pad 39B and Starship launches from Pad 39A.

GRAPHIC: NASA · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Artemis III, now planned for 2027, will send four astronauts to low Earth orbit for about two weeks to rendezvous and dock with test articles of both crewed lunar landers before astronauts begin landing near the Moon's south pole in 2028, NASA said Friday. The crew is NASA's Randy Bresnik, Frank Rubio and Andre Douglas and ESA's Luca Parmitano (NASA; NASA blog). Asked whether NASA was keeping options to launch Blue Moon Mark 2 on another rocket, Artemis program manager Jeremy Parsons and Administrator Jared Isaacman said Blue Origin is exceeding expectations and there are no plans to do so, Spaceflight Now reported (paraphrased).

Blue Origin will launch its Blue Moon Mark 2 test article first, to a circular orbit about 273 miles (237 nautical miles) high, where it can wait up to 30 days. Days later, Orion will launch on the Space Launch System from Kennedy Space Center into an 18-by-1,122-mile orbit and climb to a circular orbit of about 345 miles before docking with Blue Moon, where the crew will spend about two days inside the lander. A Starship Version 3 test article will then launch from Florida into a 206-nautical-mile orbit; Orion will dock at its nose for up to two hours, and the crew will not enter it. Orion will then have up to five more days in orbit before splashing down in the Pacific off California (NASA). "We're launching three spacecraft on three different rockets and testing how they operate together — something NASA has never attempted," Parsons said in the agency's release.

Blue Origin

The final segment of the Launch Complex 36A tower was lifted into place on Saturday (NASASpaceflight). The same day, a New Glenn second stage, GS-2, was being loaded aboard NASA's

Pegasus barge for shipment to Stennis Space Center for a static test fire (Spaceflight Now; NASASpaceflight).

Starship

Beyond Booster 22's static fire, Starship Flight 16 is being readied as the vehicle's first launch from Florida, NASASpaceflight reported. Ship 43, for Flight 16, was returning from the Massey's test site early Monday, with Ship 42, for Flight 15, taking its place (NASASpaceflight).

Rocket Lab

"With more than 100 launches in backlog (and counting), we're building a new state-of-the-art test facility to accelerate static fire stack testing for Electron and HASTE rockets," Rocket Lab posted Thursday evening. On Friday it said the Neutron team "hit some big milestones this week" at its Neutron factory in Maryland (post).

QUICK HIT

Hera. "Another successful step on Hera's approach to Didymos and Dimorphos," the European Space Agency posted Friday of its asteroid probe.

Europe and India

Arianespace named Filipe de Oliveira, who has more than 20 years in the space industry, as chief commercial officer and a member of its executive committee on Monday (post). ESA said its Argonaut lunar lander will deliver cargo and technology to the Moon's surface, "starting with its first mission from 2030" (post), and that astronaut Sophie Adenot will hold her first in-person press conference since returning from the station at its Paris headquarters on November 2 at 5:30 a.m. EST (post). ISRO will hold the space science and technology session of ESTIC 2026 at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on October 29 (post).

Comment deadlines

New Glenn at SLC-36. Comments on raising New Glenn's cap from 12 to 50 launches a year close Friday, October 30 (notice, docket FAA-2026-9841).

Part 450. Comments on five proposed changes to the commercial launch and reentry licensing rule are due November 4 (docket FAA-2026-9935).

FCC space licensing. The Federal Communications Commission's further notice of proposed rulemaking on Space Modernization for the 21st Century (SB Docket No. 25-306) was published Monday; comments are due November 25 and replies December 28 (Federal Register).

Starbase. Scoping comments on up to 456 Starship launches a year at Starbase are due November 30, with meetings November 17 to 19 (Federal Register).

VI · BY THE NUMBERS

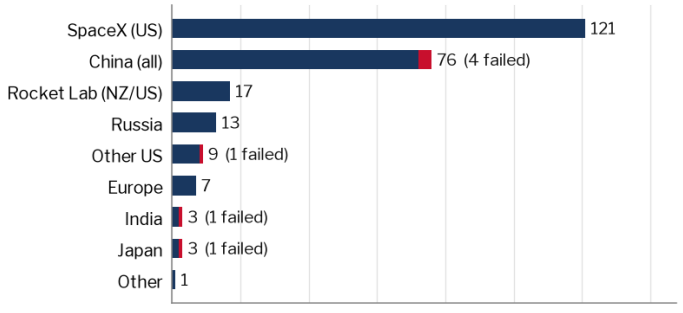
250 orbital launch attempts so far in 2026

All 18 orbital launches in October have succeeded, and half of them were SpaceX Falcons.

250	243	121	76	18
orbital launch attempts worldwide, Jan 1–Oct 25	reached orbit	by SpaceX, all successful	by China, four failures	orbital launches in October, all successful

The count

Jonathan McDowell's General Catalog of Artificial Space Objects (GCAT) records 250 orbital launch attempts through Saturday night's Long March 8A, with 243 successes. SpaceX has flown 121, all successful, followed by China with 76, Rocket Lab with 17 and Russia with 13; Europe has flown seven, other U.S. providers nine, and India and Japan three each. GCAT's updated list puts the total through October 21 at 245; Thursday's issue, which added Launch Library 2 entries to GCAT's October 15 count, reported 246.



Orbital launch attempts in 2026 by provider or country. Navy: success. Red: failure or partial failure.

CHART: THE LAUNCH REPORT · GCAT (JONATHAN MCDOWELL) THROUGH OCT 25, 02:03 UTC

The failures

According to GCAT, seven launches have failed this year: India's PSLV on January 12; China's Long March 3B on January 16, Ceres-2 on January 17, Tianlong-3 on April 3 and Long March 7A on August 10; Japan's Kairos on March 5; and Blue Origin's New Glenn on April 19, recorded as a partial failure.

October so far

Nine of this month's 18 orbital launches were SpaceX Falcons (Launch Library 2). Vandenberg has hosted five of them, more than any other site, and Cape Canaveral and Kennedy four between them. China has flown six, from Wenchang, Jiuquan, Taiyuan and a sea platform off Rizhao, while South Korea's Nuri, Japan's H3 and Rocket Lab's Electron account for the other three (Launch Library 2).

DATE, EDT	ROCKET	MISSION	SITE
Oct 1, 11:10 a.m.	Falcon 9	Crew-13	Cape Canaveral
Oct 1, 2:32 p.m.	Falcon 9	Transporter-18 rideshare	Vandenberg
Oct 1, 11:54 p.m.	Falcon Heavy	NROL-97	Kennedy
Oct 6, 11:25 p.m.	Nuri	NeonSat-2 to 6	Naro, South Korea
Oct 9, 3:27 p.m.	Long March 12	SatNet LEO Group 27	Wenchang, China
Oct 10, 3:39 a.m.	Falcon 9	SDA Tranche 1 Transport Layer A	Vandenberg
Oct 12, 8:28 p.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-25	Vandenberg
Oct 13, 6:33 a.m.	Falcon 9	CRS-35	Cape Canaveral
Oct 14, 7:40 a.m.	Zhuque-2E	10 satellites	Jiuquan, China
Oct 15, 8:01 p.m.	Falcon 9	USSF-481	Vandenberg
Oct 19, 3:41 p.m.	H3-24	MMX	Tanegashima, Japan
Oct 20, 7:04 a.m.	Falcon 9	Bandwagon-5 rideshare	Cape Canaveral
Oct 20, 11:39 p.m.	Ceres-1S	Xiguang-4 01	Sea, off Rizhao, China
Oct 23, 3:11 a.m.	**Electron**	**HawkEye 360 (3 satellites)**	**Mahia, New Zealand**
Oct 23, 6:15 a.m.	**Long March 6A**	**Yaogan-50 03**	**Taiyuan, China**
Oct 23, 3:25 p.m.	**Long March 4B**	**Six Yaogan satellites**	**Jiuquan, China**
Oct 23, 6:48 p.m.	**Falcon 9**	**Starlink 15-15**	**Vandenberg**
Oct 24, 10:03 p.m.	**Long March 8A**	**SatNet LEO Group 28**	**Wenchang, China**

The week ahead

Three orbital launches have specific dates between Monday and November 2 in Launch Library 2: two SpaceX Falcon 9s from Vandenberg and ISRO's GSLV. If all fly on schedule, October would end with 21 orbital launches and SpaceX would reach 123 for the year.

Both Vandenberg Starlinks fly on veteran boosters. Starlink 15-15 was B1063's 36th flight (NASASpaceflight), and B1082 is set for its 26th on Starlink 15-16 (Spaceflight Now). The first firm November dates belong to two more Vandenberg flights on Thursday, November 5: Starlink 15-21 at 12:14 a.m. EST, on B1103's seventh flight (Spaceflight Now), and NROL-195 for the National Reconnaissance Office at 5:34 p.m. EST (Launch Library 2). Later in the month, Arianespace's VA271 is set to carry 36 Amazon Leo satellites on the 10th Ariane 6, no earlier than November 23 (Spaceflight Now).

Takeaways

1. Five launches since Thursday all succeeded, for 250 attempts this year.
2. Starlink 15-15 flew Friday after three scrubs; 15-16 is now Tuesday at 12:45 a.m. EDT.
3. Vulcan's Amazon Leo LV-01 launch has slipped into November.
4. Artemis III will test both lunar landers in Earth orbit in 2027.
5. Starship's Booster 22 completed a full-duration static fire ahead of Flight 15.

KEY DATES AHEAD (EDT)

Mon Oct 26	Stratolaunch Erebus airspace window, 9 a.m.–1 p.m.
Tue Oct 27	Starlink 15-16, 12:45 a.m.; Aureole 2 reentry predicted
Thu Oct 29	ISRO at ESTIC 2026, New Delhi
Fri Oct 30	Starlink 15-18, 12:02 a.m.; GSLV with NVS-03, 2:21 p.m.; Rassvet-3 17 reentry predicted; New Glenn comments close
NET Nov 3	Long March 12A Flight 2; Electron "The Sea God Surveys"
Wed Nov 4	Part 450 comments due
Thu Nov 5	Starlink 15-21, 12:14 a.m. EST; NROL-195, 5:34 p.m. EST

SOURCES

Schedules: Launch Library 2 (The Space Devs), Spaceflight Now, NASASpaceflight, FAA operations plan advisory. Agencies: NASA, ESA, ISRO, FAA, FCC, Federal Register, Xinhua. Tracking: CelesTrak, The Aerospace Corporation, GCAT (Jonathan McDowell). X posts: @SpaceflightNow, @NASASpaceflight, @RocketLab, @SpaceX, @Space_Station, @esa, @Arianespace, @isro. Photos and graphics: NASA (public domain). Maps: Natural Earth (public domain).

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